

John Escobedo

Senior QA Lead | AI Validation & LLM Output QA | Accessibility (508/WCAG) & User-Centered Testing

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(512) 299-3269

Austin, Texas

Summary: Senior QA lead with 18+ years testing across healthcare, government, e-commerce, and emerging AI systems. Bringing traditional QA rigor to AI products through LLM output validation, red-teaming, prompt engineering, and hallucination detection, on a foundation of hands-on .NET/Java platform testing, SOAP/REST API testing via Postman, and daily JIRA/Confluence use. Trilingual (English, Spanish, ASL) with 508/WCAG accessibility experience including JAWS and NVDA validation.

SKILLS

Test Strategies: UAT, Regression, Agile, Functional, Integration, Smoke, Sanity, Exploratory, Black Box, System, Usability, End-to-end, API, Acceptance, 508 Compliance, HIPAA Compliance, Cross-browser, Cross-platform, Mobile, Desktop, Web Application, Release Validation, Data Integrity, Compatibility, Verification, Validation Testing

Manual Testing & QA Process: Manual Testing, Test Planning, Test Case Design, Bug Reporting, Test Strategy Writing, QA Process Implementation

API Testing: SOAP API Testing, REST API Testing, Postman, Chrome Developer Tools

Platform Testing: .NET Platform Testing, Java Platform Testing, Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (PC/Mac/Linux), Cross-browser/Cross-platform

Business Analysis: Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Process Mapping & Documentation, Gap Analysis

Leadership & Process: QA Process Implementation, Team Leadership, Process Standardization, SDLC

Testing Methodologies & Frameworks: Agile Testing, Regression Testing, User Acceptance Testing (UAT), Test Planning

AI & Prompt Engineering: Prompt Engineering & Optimization, AI Red Teaming & Adversarial Testing, LLM Output Validation & QA, Hallucination Detection & Fact-Checking

Test Management & Documentation: JIRA/Xray, JIRA Administration, Confluence, TestRail

Accessibility & Inclusive Design: 508 Compliance Testing, WCAG Awareness, JAWS Screen Reader, NVDA Screen Reader

Platforms & Environments: Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (PC, Mac, Linux), Cross-browser/Cross-platform

Tools & Technologies: GitHub, Chrome Developer Tools, SQL / JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS

Industry Expertise: Healthcare & Telehealth, Gaming & Entertainment, Educational Technology, Live Events & Hosting

Office and Image Suites: Adobe Creative Suite, Office 365: Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Google Workspace: Drive, Docs, Sheets, Canva

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.

- Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
 - Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.
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Robot Tele-Operator

Apptronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX

July 2025 to September 2025

Tested and documented humanoid robot behavior for Apptronik, writing procedures and bug reports engineering could act on directly.

- Cut physical test setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, giving data collection consistent, repeatable conditions.
 - Turned observed robot behaviors into clear bug reports engineering could act on immediately.
 - Wrote startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, cutting new-tester ramp-up time by roughly 50% and becoming the team standard.
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Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
 - Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
 - Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
 - Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
 - Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
 - Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
 - Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
 - Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.
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Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX

June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
- Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
- Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
- Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX
July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
- Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
- Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX
May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
- Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
- Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

Communication Services for the Deaf

(2013–2015)

Built the QA function for a video interpreting platform serving Deaf and hard-of-hearing users, immersing in the community to shape testing around real user needs.

- Learned American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs firsthand, using that immersion as a user research approach that shaped requirements validation.
- Established the company's first-ever QA function, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that caught non-functional code blocking release.
- Owned validation across web and mobile, from test planning through stakeholder reporting.
- Expanded test coverage to previously unreachable environments by implementing a VirtualBox-based cross-platform solution.

Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester

DocbookMD

(2012–2013)

Founded the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, establishing regulatory-grade quality processes and validation strategy from zero.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring the app met regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
- Built the initial test strategy and QA documentation from scratch, gating releases against both business and HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Ran functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, creatively simulating wifi outages to catch edge cases scripted testing misses.

QA Test Lead | QA Tester

Luna Data Solutions

(2011–2012)

Contracted as QA Tester at Heatwave Interactive and promoted to Test Lead, authoring test documentation and leading a team across multiple game titles.

- Authored test plans and documentation for smoke and regression cycles, improving coverage and consistency.
- Led and mentored a team of testers, raising the bar on documentation quality and execution consistency.
- Ran daily validation of game builds for core functionality, gameplay mechanics, and UI integrity.

Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist

Blizzard Entertainment

(2010–2011)

Delivered high-touch customer support for World of Warcraft, analyzing complex cases and documenting findings for development teams while maintaining user trust in a high-volume environment.

- Analyzed and documented fraud and exploitation cases, delivering detailed root cause reports to development teams.
- De-escalated emotionally charged escalations through patient listening, restoring lost items and accounts and turning frustrated users into loyal ones.
- Delivered high-volume support via live chat and ticket systems, balancing efficiency with genuine care.
- Restored compromised accounts with precision, following strict security and data integrity protocols.

QA Analyst | Support Tools Developer | Community Operations

Linden Lab

(2007–2010)

Promoted three times from frontline support to QA Analyst, identifying operational gaps and building tools while establishing customer support processes.

- Built custom diagnostic tools to address operational gaps identified in support workflows.
- Established customer support processes and documentation using the Parature ticket system and live chat.
- As QA Analyst, tested daily builds and documented complex issues for engineering handoff.
- Served as frontline First Responder, handling in-world emergencies, enforcing Terms of Service, and resolving user conflicts.

QA Tester

Super Happy Fun Fun

(2006–2007)

Cross-platform compatibility testing for mobile games across 100+ device models, documenting platform-specific issues and building strategies for fragmented environments.

- Ran functional and compatibility testing across 100+ unique device models, building strategies for efficient testing across fragmented hardware and software platforms.
- Tracked platform-specific bugs in Mantis with detailed analysis for developers.
- Maintained quality oversight from initial builds through production patches.

QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester

Aspyr Media

(2006–2006)

Handled QA for high-profile Mac game ports, authoring test documentation and partnering with development to isolate platform-specific issues.

- Authored test protocols and documentation to guide the testing team and establish organized standards.
- Validated major titles including Call of Duty 2 and Civilization IV through functional, compatibility, and regression testing, partnering with developers to isolate Mac-specific issues for stable launches.
- Documented, tracked, and verified defects in JIRA and DevTrack with clear, actionable reports.
- Caught localization and UI text errors through exhaustive proofreading, improving the polish of shipped titles.

EDUCATION

Austin Community College - Austin, TX

American Sign Language
2015 – 2017

ASL School - Austin, TX

American Sign Language
2008 – 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 – 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 – 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 – 1995

Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>